

RAILWAYS IN WARTIME

The Indian Railways, its resources and people have always been co-opted to aid the war effort. They have supported the armies at the frontlines, provided supplies, and even run trains in enemy territory, often at great risk to themselves.



▲ **Members of the Railway Territorial Army** working on rail tracks in Pakistan in 1971.

The railways played a crucial role in the country's defence during the colonial era. The Railway Volunteers, as they were called, were made up exclusively of European and Eurasian railway employees who attended annual camps and received basic training. The Indian Railways' Territorial Army (TA) was formed in 1949 as an auxiliary unit to maintain essential rail transportation in peacetime and to ensure links and